HITSCHOOL · B2 FIRST CERTIFICATE · READING PRACTICE

Artificial Intelligence in the Classroom

Level: B2 Upper-Intermediate · Reading time: 8 minutes · Unit 3: Technology

> **Before you read:** Read the article carefully. You will need this information to answer the Unit 3 Assessment in the next step of the task.

A quiet revolution

Only a decade ago, the idea of a computer helping a teenager with an English essay sounded like science fiction. Today, artificial intelligence has quietly made its way into thousands of classrooms. Language apps correct pronunciation in real time, online platforms mark grammar exercises in seconds, and teachers can follow the progress of every student without spending their evenings with a red pen.

What teachers say

Most teachers agree that technology has *freed up* their time rather than replaced them. "By the time I arrive at school, the homework has already been corrected," explains Sarah, an English teacher in Seville. "That means I can focus on speaking activities, which is exactly what my students need before the Cambridge exam."

However, not everyone is convinced. Some educators worry that students may rely too heavily on automatic tools and stop thinking for themselves. They argue that writing and speaking require creativity, something that no algorithm can fully evaluate.

The students' point of view

Students, on the other hand, are generally enthusiastic. Instant feedback means they know immediately what they got wrong and why. "I used to wait a whole week to get my test back," says Lucas, 17. "Now I see my mark straight away and I can practise the mistakes the same day."

Looking ahead

Experts predict that, by 2030, most language schools will have combined human teaching with intelligent platforms. The challenge will not be the technology itself, but finding the

right balance: machines for repetitive tasks, and people for motivation, conversation and real communication.

> **Key vocabulary:**
>
> - **to free up** – to make time or space available
> - **to rely on** – to depend on
> - **straight away** – immediately
> - **balance** – a situation in which different elements are equal